



KEVIN DIETSCH Getty Images

RETURN ENGAGEMENT

Dodgers manager Dave Roberts speaks as players, staff and President Trump listen during a visit in the Rose Garden of the White House to mark the team’s second consecutive World Series title. **SPORTS, B10**

Measles surges in children, young adults

Some cases in the state are coming from travelers. Infants are especially at risk.

By RONG-GONG LIN II

Measles cases have doubled in California so far this year compared with last year — and 2026 is barely half over.

California has confirmed 52 measles cases in the first 6½ months of the year; that’s more than double the 25 cases reported in 2025.

If this pace continues, the number of cases will be the highest since 2015, when there were 125 cases in the state and a portion of them were related to a large outbreak at Disneyland.

Of this year’s 52 cases, 49 patients either were unvaccinated or had an unknown vaccination record. Four have had to be hospitalized. Many cases involve children or young adults — 27 cases involved those ages 5 to 19, and 15 cases involved children under 5 years old, according to the California Department of Public Health. L.A. County has tallied seven cases so far this year among its residents.

Nationally, measles cases have nearly eclipsed last year’s total already and the country is poised to hit its highest case level since the late 1980s and early ’90s. As of mid-July, 2,260 measles cases were reported, compared with 2,289 in all of last year. Last year’s tally was the highest in a single year since the devastating 1989-91 measles epidemic, which resulted in more than 55,000 cases and 166 suspected deaths.

The U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention said 93% of confirmed measles cases are associated with outbreaks. There have been 34 new outbreaks re-

[See Measles, A7]

California avoids worst of Colorado River cuts

Arizona, Nevada also won’t face harshest water limits that could have been imposed.

By IAN JAMES

California and two other states have avoided the harshest water cutbacks the Trump administration could have imposed over the next two years to deal with the deepening crisis on the Colorado River.

The Times has learned that federal officials have agreed with an offer made

this year by California, Arizona and Nevada to reduce what they take from the river by at least 3.2 million acre-feet between now and the end of 2028.

Under the plan, California will cut its use of Colorado River water by about 12% through 2028, Arizona will take about 31% less and Nevada 28% less, according to two officials at state and local agencies who spoke anonymously because details of an announcement are still being finalized.

In May, the three states proposed these cuts for the next 2½ years, and now the federal government is set to

sign off on much of their proposal. The Trump administration could have required cuts nearly twice as large.

The Colorado River provides water for about 35 million people and 5 million acres of farmland, from the Rocky Mountains to Southern California and northern Mexico. It has shrunk dramatically in the last 27 years, and research shows climate change is intensifying the extremely dry conditions.

The Trump administration’s two-year blueprint aims to strike a compromise between two quarreling groups: the three down-

[See Water, A6]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

RESIDENTS near the Lineage warehouse are dealing with fly infestations.

Giant rats, putrid smells

Boyle Heights residents describe conditions they face weeks after a fire at a cold storage warehouse

By Salvador Hernandez

Along Union Pacific Avenue in Boyle Heights, rat traps sit about every 10 feet along the sidewalk, with the aim of catching hungry rodents drawn to the burned-out warehouse holding millions of pounds of rotting meat.

But Lisett Navarrete, a 34-year-old resident, has little faith that they’ll do the job.

“It’s not like little house rats. They’re giant rats,” she says. “They don’t fit there.”

Since the Lineage cold storage warehouse burned last month, the company has been trying to remove tons of rotting

meat.

But with temperatures spiking, the crisis over smoke from the fire has given way to a second crisis over putrid smells, insects, rodents and growing concerns over sanitation.

To hear neighbors tell it, the deodorizers, misters and other efforts to mitigate the issues aren’t enough. There are flies, rats and, if the wind shifts ever so slightly, a waft of thick, nauseating air from the warehouse.

“We can’t run away from it, it’s all around us,” Navarrete said. “It smells so bad, you don’t

[See Warehouse, A12]

Homelessness rises, dealing a setback to Bass

Past progress has been key to mayor’s case for reelection. New count reverses trend.

By DAVID ZAHNISER AND DOUG SMITH

The number of people living on the street, both in the city of Los Angeles and across much of Los Angeles County, is up compared with the previous year, dealing a fresh blow to Mayor Karen Bass as she runs for reelection.

L.A.’s unsheltered homeless population — those living outdoors or in their vehicles — went up by 7.9% after two consecutive years of decreases, according to two people familiar with the numbers presented by the Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority in closed-door briefings.

Overall homelessness, which includes those living in shelters and other temporary facilities, increased by 3.4% compared with the previous year, those sources

said.

Both asked to remain unnamed because they were not authorized to publicly discuss LAHSA’s presentation, which focused on this year’s annual point-in-time count conducted in January.

The numbers represent a significant setback for Bass, who is seeking a second term in the Nov. 3 election and has made the fight against homelessness a central part of her agenda, touting her administration’s progress in moving people indoors.

Bass, in a statement, attributed the increases to an array of issues, including funding cuts by the state and federal governments. She described a lack of adequate county services, such as mental health and substance counseling, as a contributor to the crisis.

Even with those obstacles, the city has reduced unsheltered homelessness by 11% since 2023, while also housing more than 1,000 homeless veterans, Bass said.

“This crisis was ignored by city leaders for decades, [See Homelessness, A7]

Iran war widens as Saudi tankers are struck in Red Sea

By KEVIN RECTOR, NABIH BULOS AND ANA CEBALLOS

The U.S. war with Iran escalated again Thursday as Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen attacked two Saudi Arabian oil tankers in the Red Sea, causing global oil prices to surge amid fears of yet another vital energy corridor being choked off by the conflict.

The attacks came after the Trump administration threatened additional strikes on Iran’s nuclear infrastructure while pushing a new deal to help Saudi Arabia develop a nuclear energy program of its own. Also Thursday, four Republicans in the U.S. House joined Democrats in a vote to halt the American military campaign absent congressional approval. Senate Republicans blocked a similar measure.

The price of oil hit \$100 a barrel for the first time since May, increasing the financial pressure on Americans at the gas pump and the politi-

cal pressure on President Trump to end a war he promised would last weeks but has persisted for months. At least 18 U.S. service members have died in the war.

The Houthis, who control the populous northwest of Yemen, receive arms and training from Tehran but had remained largely on the sidelines since the U.S. and Israel launched the war. Their latest strikes complicate already fraught negotiations between the U.S. and Iran after the collapse of a ceasefire this month amid renewed hostilities in the Strait of Hormuz, the other major energy passageway choked by the conflict.

The Houthis had this week announced a naval blockade of Saudi ships in the Red Sea, which stretches along Saudi Arabia’s western flank. That blockade centered on the Bab al Mandab strait, the only southbound route for Saudi tankers headed to Asian markets.

Tanker traffic has al-

[See War, A6]



J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE Associated Press

HOUSE members leave for a five-week recess after the chamber voted to halt the U.S. military campaign.

CSU official rehired after settlement

Board OKs \$343,000 “transition” job for Tomás Morales, who was accused of bias. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Graffiti Towers cleanup begins

Crews are working to remove vandalism while the \$517-million sale closes. **BUSINESS, A10**

Weather

Mostly sunny; warm. L.A. Basin: 91/68. **B6**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Drinking water effort faces cuts

A decrease in funding to address contamination threatens progress in the state. **CLIMATE, A9**

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Protections at risk for detained migrant kids

By SONJA SHARP

For more than a quarter-century, a lawsuit settlement from a case brought in Los Angeles federal court has dictated conditions for children held in immigration detention.

But now, the long-standing settlement — which set minimum standards for housing, education and medical care for migrant kids in federal custody, while

strictly limiting how long they can remain there — hangs in the balance in the 9th Circuit Court of Appeals after a challenge by the Trump administration.

At the same time, the federal judge in L.A. who presides over the agreement appears poised to appoint a powerful new enforcer to uphold it.

President Trump has long sought to scrap the Flores settlement, which dates back to the Clinton era. In

recent months, the Trump administration has waged a legal battle to cancel the agreement, while also pleading with the district court not to order an independent monitor to boost its compliance.

“[Flores] is the only thing standing between them and indefinite detention of families,” said Leecia Welch, chief legal director at Children’s Rights, a plaintiff in the case.

Last month, Assistant

Atty. Gen. Brett A. Shumate pressed the 9th Circuit Court to give the administration “the thumbs-up or thumbs-down” on its bid to tear up the settlement and end what he called “judicial micromanagement” of federal immigration policy.

“The Flores consent decree is an agreement which goes well above the constitutional floor,” Shumate told the court during oral arguments in June. “We’re asking

[See Detention, A8]